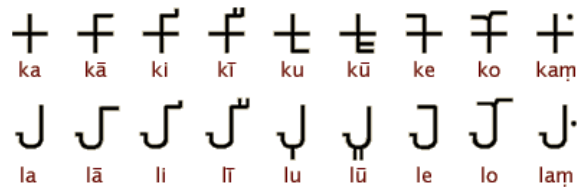


## Problem #6: Deciphering the Brahmi Script (20 marks)

### Solution:

By comparing the transcription of the first line, one can figure out that the Brahmi script is an *abugida* that is written from left to right. Abugidas are a class of scripts where each consonant has a symbol. The vowel sounds are indicated using special marks, called *diacritics* or *maatras* (in Hindi), around the consonant symbols. Absence of any maatraa indicates the vowel 'a'. The dot is used for indicating *m*, i.e., a *homorganic nasal sound* (similar to the *bindi* in Devanagari, also called the *anuswar*). For example,



### Assignment 1:

The word **pari** is not in the edict. This can be deduced by observing that throughout the text, 'p' only occurs with 'i' and 'e' *maatraa*, and never without any *maatraa*. Therefore, there is not 'pa' in the text, and hence, 'pari' cannot be in the text.

### Assignment 2:

|       |      |          |      |               |          |
|-------|------|----------|------|---------------|----------|
| etaṃ  | ▷𑀓𑀭  | nocujane | 𑀓𑀭𑀓𑀭 | ca            | d        |
| esame | ▷𑀓𑀭𑀓 | ichisu   | 𑀓𑀭𑀓𑀭 | dhammavaḍhiyā | 𑀓𑀭𑀓𑀭𑀓𑀭𑀓𑀭 |

### Assignment 3:

|           |                 |
|-----------|-----------------|
| ▷𑀓𑀭𑀓𑀭𑀓𑀭𑀓𑀭 | evamapipacatesu |
| 𑀓𑀭        | dhammā          |
| 𑀓𑀭𑀓𑀭𑀓𑀭    | samādiyāmi      |

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